ShopEase Customer Support Knowledge Base

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Audience: ShopEase Customer Support Executives (Level 1 & Level 2), Escalation Managers, Logistics Partners

1. Introduction

This document serves as the comprehensive guide for resolving complex customer scenarios and edge cases at ShopEase. It outlines the standard operating procedures (SOPs) to ensure consistent, fair, and efficient resolution of issues, maintaining our commitment to customer satisfaction while safeguarding company policies.

2. Order Delivery Issues

2.1. Partial Delivery (Items Missing from Shipment)

Scenario: The customer reports receiving their package, but one or more items from their order are missing.

Investigation Steps:

1. **Verify Order Status:** Confirm the order status in the system. Check if the missing items were split into a separate shipment (check for multiple tracking IDs).
2. **Review Packaging Logs:** Access the warehouse packaging logs and video surveillance records (if applicable for high-value items) to verify if the item was included in the package.
3. **Check Delivery Agent Notes:** Review any notes left by the delivery agent regarding package condition or potential tampering.
4. **Request Evidence from Customer:** Ask the customer to provide clear photographs of the received package (showing all sides), the items received, and the shipping label.

Resolution Protocol:

- **If missing items were shipped separately:** Inform the customer of the separate tracking ID and the expected delivery date. Apologize for the confusion.
- **If warehouse error is confirmed (item not packed):** Immediately initiate a replacement order for the missing items. If the items are out of stock, process a full refund to the original payment method. Offer a complimentary ShopEase voucher (value ₹100 - ₹500 based on order value) for the inconvenience.
- **If package tampering is suspected (during transit):** Escalate the issue to the Logistics

Partner Support Team for investigation. Concurrently, initiate a replacement or refund for the customer to prevent delay.

2.2. Order Lost in Transit

Scenario: The tracking status has not updated for more than 5 business days past the estimated delivery date, and the logistics partner cannot locate the package.

Investigation Steps:

1. **Verify Tracking:** Confirm the prolonged lack of updates on the carrier's tracking portal.
2. **Contact Logistics Partner:** Open a formal inquiry with the designated logistics partner regarding the missing shipment. Obtain a ticket number.

Resolution Protocol:

- **If Logistics Partner confirms loss:** Immediately initiate a replacement order or a full refund to the original payment method, per the customer's preference. Do not wait for the logistics partner's internal claims process to conclude before resolving the customer's issue.
- **If Logistics Partner needs more time (up to 48 hours):** Inform the customer of the investigation. Set an expectation for an update within 48 hours. If unresolved after 48 hours, proceed with replacement or refund.

2.3. Delivery Refused at Door (Cash on Delivery - COD)

Scenario: The customer refuses to accept a COD order when the delivery agent attempts delivery.

Investigation Steps:

1. **Review Delivery Agent Notes:** Check the reason for refusal provided by the delivery agent (e.g., "Customer not available," "Refused by customer," "Address not found").
2. **Contact Customer:** If the refusal reason is unclear or indicates a potential issue (e.g., "Package appeared damaged"), contact the customer to understand their reason for refusal.

Resolution Protocol:

- **Standard Refusal:** The package will be returned to the origin (RTO). No further action is required for the customer, as payment was not collected.
- **Frequent Refusals (Flagged Accounts):** If a customer has a history of multiple COD refusals (more than 3 in a 6-month period), their account may be temporarily suspended or COD privileges revoked, pending review by the Risk Management team.
- **Refusal Due to Damaged Packaging:** Document the customer's concern. Ensure the logistics partner flags the RTO reason correctly to initiate a quality check upon return to the warehouse.

2.4. Wrong Address Entered After Dispatch

Scenario: The customer realizes they entered the wrong shipping address after the order has already been dispatched.

Investigation Steps:

1. **Verify Order Status:** Confirm that the order status is "Dispatched" or "In Transit."
2. **Assess Modification Feasibility:** Check with the specific logistics partner if a change of address (COA) request is possible while the package is in transit.

Resolution Protocol:

- **If COA is possible:** Attempt to intercept the package and update the delivery address with the logistics partner. Inform the customer that this may cause a delay of 2-4 business days.
- **If COA is not possible:** Inform the customer that the address cannot be changed post-dispatch.
    - If the package is delivered to the wrong address, ShopEase is not liable.
    - If the package is undeliverable and returned to origin (RTO), a refund (minus shipping charges, if applicable) will be processed once the package is received back at the warehouse. The customer must place a new order with the correct address.

3. Product Authenticity and Quality Issues

3.1. Counterfeit or Fake Product Received

Scenario: The customer alleges that the product received is a counterfeit, replica, or fake version of the ordered item.

Investigation Steps:

1. **Escalation:** Immediately escalate the ticket to Level 2 Support and the Vendor Management Team. This is a high-priority issue.
2. **Gather Evidence:** Request clear, high-resolution photographs from the customer showing the product, packaging, branding details, and any discrepancies that led them to believe it's counterfeit.
3. **Vendor Verification:** The Vendor Management Team must contact the seller/vendor and request proof of authenticity (e.g., invoices from authorized distributors, brand authorization letters).

Resolution Protocol:

- **If Authenticity is Confirmed (False Alarm):** Provide the customer with the vendor's proof of authenticity. Politely explain the findings. If the customer remains dissatisfied, process a standard return/refund under the standard return policy.
- **If Counterfeit is Confirmed (or Vendor Cannot Provide Proof):**
    1. Immediately process a full refund to the customer's original payment method, inclusive of any shipping fees.
    2. Provide a sincere apology and a ShopEase voucher (value ₹500 - ₹2000 based on

severity) as goodwill.
3. The Vendor Management Team will take appropriate action against the seller, which may include suspension or permanent delisting from the platform, as per the Seller Agreement.

4. Return and Exchange Scenarios

4.1. Exchange Policy Overview

General Policy: ShopEase offers exchanges for the same product in a different size or color, subject to stock availability, within the specified return window (typically 7-15 days, depending on the product category). We do not offer exchanges for entirely different products.

Resolution Protocol:

1. Verify the item is eligible for exchange and within the return window.
2. Confirm the availability of the requested size/color in stock.
3. Initiate the exchange request. The customer must return the original item in its original condition, with all tags and packaging intact.
4. Once the original item is received and passes quality check at the warehouse, the replacement item will be dispatched.

4.2. Item Damaged During Return Pickup

Scenario: The customer reports that the item was damaged by the logistics partner during the return pickup process.

Investigation Steps:

1. **Request Evidence from Customer:** Ask the customer for any photographs or documentation proving the item was intact before pickup and damaged during handling (this can be difficult to prove, so proceed with empathy).
2. **Review Logistics Notes:** Check the return pickup log for any notes regarding the condition of the package at pickup.
3. **Review Warehouse Receiving Logs:** Check the condition of the package upon arrival at the warehouse.

Resolution Protocol:

- **Benefit of the Doubt:** Generally, if a customer claims damage during return transit, ShopEase will offer the benefit of the doubt, especially if the customer has a good history.
- **Process Refund:** Process the refund as requested.
- **Internal Claim:** File a claim with the logistics partner for damage during transit. Do not penalize the customer for this issue.

5. Payment and Pricing Issues

5.1. Refund Processed but Money Not Credited

Scenario: The customer's order shows "Refund Processed" in the ShopEase system, but the customer claims the money has not appeared in their bank account or credit card statement.

Investigation Steps:

1. **Verify Refund Status:** Confirm the refund has been successfully initiated and processed on our end. Note the processing date and the payment gateway used.
2. **Check Bank Timelines:** Remind the customer of standard bank processing times (typically 5-7 business days for credit cards, 3-5 business days for debit cards/UPI).

Resolution Protocol:

- **If within standard processing time:** Reassure the customer that the refund has been initiated and request they wait the full processing period.
- **If past standard processing time:**
    1. Provide the customer with the Bank Reference Number (BRN) or Acquirer Reference Number (ARN) associated with the refund transaction.
    2. Instruct the customer to contact their bank or card issuer with this reference number to trace the funds. ShopEase cannot directly intervene with the customer's bank.

5.2. Duplicate Order Placed by Mistake

Scenario: A customer accidentally placed two identical orders and wishes to cancel one.

Investigation Steps:

1. **Identify Duplicate:** Locate both orders in the system and verify they are indeed duplicates (same items, same address, placed closely together in time).
2. **Check Order Status:** Determine if the duplicate order has been dispatched.

Resolution Protocol:

- **If Duplicate is Unfulfilled/Processing:** Immediately cancel the duplicate order and process a full refund. Inform the customer of the successful cancellation.
- **If Duplicate is Dispatched:** Inform the customer that the order is already in transit. Advise them to refuse delivery of the second package when it arrives. Once the refused package is RTO (Returned to Origin), a full refund will be processed automatically.

5.3. Price Difference Refund After Purchase

Scenario: A customer purchases an item, and within a short period (e.g., the next day), the item goes on sale or the price drops on ShopEase. The customer requests a refund for the price difference.

Resolution Protocol:

- **Standard Policy:** ShopEase does **not** offer price-matching or post-purchase price adjustments. Prices fluctuate based on market demand and promotional periods.

- **Customer Communication:** Politely inform the customer of this policy. Explain that while we cannot refund the difference, they are welcome to return the item (if eligible under the standard return policy) and repurchase it at the new, lower price. Note that they may be responsible for return shipping costs depending on the specific return policy for that item.